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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Pritzker wants voices heard

Governor asks Dems to take to streets in protest of president

By Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

Gov. JB Pritzker and three other Democratic state chief executives on Tuesday night called for Democrats to mobilize and protest outside Republican congressional offices to oppose President Donald Trump's administrative actions following his first 100 days in office.

"If you're not out there protesting in front of a Republican congressman's office, or out in the street making your voice heard, or calling your friends in another state to have them do it, or showing up in Washington, D.C., in front of their offices, those Republican congressmen, then you're not doing what's necessary to put pressure on them to vote the right way," he said.

Pritzker was joined by Govs. Tim Walz of Minnesota, the unsuccessful 2024 vice presidential nominee, Maura Healey of Massachusetts and Kathy Hochul of New York in an hourlong, livestreamed question-and-answer event hosted by the MeidasTouch Network. The online site has used social media platforms and other channels to sharply criticize Trump and Elon Musk, the presidential adviser who heads up the Department of Government Efficiency.

The governors were asked about formulating a new messaging strategy following the party's poor showing last November and current public

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CHICAGO PUBLIC SCHOOLS

Feds assail program for Black students

Investigation is latest White House action targeting the district

By Nell Salzman
Chicago Tribune

The federal government launched an investigation into Chicago Public Schools on Tuesday related to allegations of discrimination in the district's Black Student Success Plan.

The plan to improve the educational experiences and outcomes of the district's Black students was solidified in 2021 legislation that remade Chicago's school board into an elected body, following decades of mayoral appointees. Activists who championed it argued that Black students were uniquely positioned to fail because of long-standing racial inequalities in Chicago and the result of historic and ongoing discrimination in the United States.

But students of all races struggle academically in Chicago, according to a news release issued Tuesday by the U.S. Department of Education's Office for Civil Rights.

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Mayor Brandon Johnson walks between meetings at the State Capitol on Wednesday in Springfield. BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A 'modest' wish list

In Springfield, mayor stumps for funding he says will benefit both city and state

By Jeremy Gorner, Alice Yin and Addison Wright
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — Mayor Brandon Johnson touted his Springfield agenda as both "modest" and beneficial to the whole state of Illinois during a short Wednesday stop at the statehouse, where he has had a hard time scoring points for Chicago during a tough state budget season.

It was Johnson's first visit to the General Assembly since May

2024, when he came home with lackluster results for the city. But faced with ongoing reluctance from lawmakers and Gov. JB Pritzker, the mayor fine-tuned his message to hone in on the idea that helping Chicago will help the rest of the state.

"This is about what we have to do as an entire state to ensure that all of Illinois is supported," the mayor told reporters ahead of his Wednesday meeting with the Democratic governor. "My responsibility is the city of

Chicago. Our presentation is actually quite modest. The overall, ongoing issues for revenue, that will benefit the entire state."

The mayor also hopes that Republican President Donald Trump's second term — and the potential for the White House to deprive Chicago and Illinois of key federal funding — has increased the urgency for state leaders to move on his Springfield wish list.

Johnson first met with the governor for about half an hour.

He then convened with the General Assembly's two Democratic leaders, Senate President Don Harmon of Oak Park and House Speaker Emanuel "Chris" Welch of Hillside.

In a short statement about their huddle, a Pritzker spokesperson said the governor "appreciated the opportunity to discuss the city's priorities and our shared goals."

"Our priority remains passing

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"I bear no tension against anyone. I don't. If anyone believes that politicians all sit around thinking how we can be each other's godchildren's parents, that's not reality. Just because you have disagreement, doesn't mean that that's an obstacle. That's called democracy."

— Mayor Brandon Johnson, on whether his previous discord with Gov. JB Pritzker will impede state funding for the city

CHICAGO CITY COUNCIL



Ald. Bill Conway, 34th, is flanked by Ald. Raymond Lopez, 15th, and Ald. Silvana Tabares, 23rd, as they talk during a meeting of the Public Safety Committee on Wednesday. ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

'Snap' teen curfew hits hurdle

By Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

Aldermen waffled Wednesday on a proposal to give Chicago's top public safety leaders the power to declare "snap curfews" in an effort to curb so-called teen takeovers, delaying a vote on the contentious idea after a five-hour debate.

Facing a razor-thin roll call and requests for more time, along with deep concerns from

opponents about how officials might use the new curfew authority, Ald. Brian Hopkins called off the vote on his ordinance in the City Council's Public Safety Committee.

The decision stalls an effort by some aldermen to decisively shape Chicago's policing policy in response to a handful of high-profile violent incidents at large gatherings of teens, with or without Mayor Brandon Johnson's support. But Hopkins said

the committee he chairs will vote on the measure soon, possibly next week, and added he is confident it will pass.

"We've come too far in a collaborative spirit with the discussion right now to use a heavy hand and force this through," said Hopkins, who has aggressively pushed for police to get more curfew powers since two recent large

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INSIDE

Consent decree to remain for Chicago

One of the executive orders signed by President Donald Trump on Monday seeks to end all federal consent decrees governing reform efforts by police departments across the country. But Chicago's consent decree, which has been in place since 2019, isn't going anywhere, according to the Office of the Illinois Attorney General.

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Economy drops for first time in 3 years

The U.S. economy shrank at a 0.3% annual pace from January through March, the first drop in three years, as President Donald Trump's trade wars disrupted business. First-quarter growth was slowed by a surge in imports as companies in the United States tried to bring in foreign goods before Trump imposed massive tariffs. Nation & World in Business, Page 6

Sky preseason tilt is a homecoming

Sky guard Hailey Van Lith never thought her first game in a WNBA jersey would take her back to Baton Rouge, La., where she spent the toughest year of her collegiate career with LSU. Chicago Sports

